IT support hours and escalation contacts

Article KB0010093 | Owner: Service Desk L1 | Subcategory: General | Applies to: All Acme Global employees, Remote and office-based staff, Windows 11, macOS laptops, Mobile devices, Any device accessing IT services

Summary

This article explains Acme Global's IT support hours, contact methods, and escalation paths for urgent issues. It provides users with a self-help procedure to verify current support availability and find the right contacts, and gives service-desk agents a clear process for handling after-hours requests and logging P1 incidents.

Symptoms

- User is unsure whether IT support is currently available
- User attempts to contact the IT Service Desk outside published hours and receives no response
- User needs to know whom to call for a critical (P1) issue after normal business hours

Common causes

- Lack of awareness of the published support schedule (Mon-Fri 08:00-20:00 IST)
- Confusion between the self-service portal, phone extension, and Teams channel
- Unclear escalation path for P1 incidents that require 24x7 phone support

Understanding IT Support Hours

Acme Global's IT Service Desk provides support via the self-service portal at https://it.acme.example, phone extension 4357 (HELP), and the Teams channel "IT Help". Regular hours are Monday through Friday, 08:00 to 20:00 IST. During these hours, L1 analysts handle all incoming requests and aim to meet the priority-based resolution targets (P1 4?h, P2 8?h, P3 24?h, P4 72?h). For Priority?1 (Critical) incidents, phone support is available 24?hours a day, 7?days a week, even outside the regular window.

Self-Help: Checking Current Status and Finding Contacts

Follow these steps to verify whether IT support is currently available and to locate the appropriate contact method for your situation.

1. Open a web browser and go to the IT self-service portal: https://it.acme.example. The banner at the top of the page displays the current support status (e.g., "Support Open - 08:00-20:00 IST" or "After-Hours - P1 Phone Only").
2. If the portal shows regular hours, you can submit a request through the portal, start a chat in the Teams "IT Help" channel, or call extension 4357 (HELP).
3. If the portal indicates after-hours mode, remember that only P1 issues are handled via phone. Dial extension 4357 (HELP) from any internal phone or, if calling from outside, use the dial-in number provided in your welcome email.
4. For non-urgent requests outside regular hours, you can still log a ticket in the portal; it will be queued for the next business day.

Verification and Confirmation

After contacting the IT Service Desk (whether via portal, Teams, or phone), users should verify that their request has been logged and is being processed.

1. Check the self-service portal for a ticket number in the confirmation email or on-screen message after submission.
2. If you called the phone line, ask the analyst for the ticket number and repeat it back to confirm accuracy.
3. You can also search for the ticket in the portal using the number or keywords from your issue description to view its current status and any updates from the support team.

When to escalate

For any Priority?1 (Critical) incident occurring outside regular support hours (08:00-20:00 IST), call the IT Service Desk phone extension 4357 (HELP) for 24x7 P1 support. Provide the analyst with your name, employee ID, a brief impact description, and any exact error messages. The analyst will log a P1 ticket and, if needed, escalate to the relevant specialist group (IAM, Network Support, Messaging & Collaboration, or Security Operations) via the designated Teams escalation channel, including the ticket number and a summary of the problem. Non-P1 requests should be logged in the

portal for next-business-day handling.

Keywords: IT support hours, Help desk phone, Extension 4357, IT Help Teams channel, self-service portal, after-hours support, P1 escalation, critical incident, Identity & Access Management, Network Support, Messaging & Collaboration, Security Operations, ticket number, verify request